KENYA INSTITUTE OF PRIMATE RESEARCH

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W.H.O COLLABORATING CENTRE

Translating Life Science

REPUBLIC OF KENYA
MINISTRY OF HEALTH

Date: 26/10/2026

Ref: KIPRE/CEO/IDGF/NACOSTI/26/10/2026

The Director General,
National Commission for Science, Technology and Innovation (NACOSTI),
off Waiyaki Way, Upper Kabete,
P. O. Box 30623, 00100
Nairobi, Kenya.

Attention: Dr Mary Onsaringo, PhD

RE: REQUEST FOR A RESOURCE PERSON TO SUPPORT INSTITUTIONAL DATA GOVERNANCE AND RESEARCH GOVERNANCE CAPACITY DEVELOPMENT

The Kenya Institute of Primate Research (KIPRE) is a Semi-Autonomous Government Agency (SAGA) established under Legal Notice No. 273 of 2017 pursuant to the Science, Technology and Innovation Act, No. 28 of 2013. The Institute operates under the Ministry of Health, State Department for Public Health and Professional Standards, and its mandate is to improve human health through biomedical and pre-clinical research.

KIPRE is undertaking the development and institutionalisation of an Institutional Data Governance Framework (IDGF), a key deliverable under the Institute's Strategic Plan 2023–2027, scheduled for implementation within the current financial year.

To guide this process, KIPRE has developed the Institutional Data Governance Framework Development Plan (IDGFDP), which provides a structured roadmap for progressively establishing and implementing the Framework across the Institute. An important initial activity under this Plan is the establishment of a network of Data Governance Champions drawn from the Institute's directorates, divisions, departments and sections. The Champions will support the identification of existing data governance practices, institutional strengths, operational gaps, risks and priority areas requiring improvement. The findings will inform the subsequent engagement of a consultant to undertake a comprehensive institutional data governance assessment and support the development of the initial Framework.

Given NACOSTI's mandate in the regulation and promotion of science, technology and innovation, KIPRE seeks the Commission's support in this important institutional initiative. We kindly request NACOSTI to nominate a suitably qualified resource person with expertise in research governance, institutional research regulation, research quality assurance and related governance processes to participate in the proposed engagement.

The planned activity will comprise three complementary sessions:

1. **Introduction to institutional data governance:** This session will be jointly facilitated by resource persons from NACOSTI and the Kenya School of Law (KSL). It will establish a common understanding of institutional data governance, institutional accountability, research governance, and the relevant legal and regulatory obligations affecting research institutions.
2. **Fact-finding engagement with Data Governance Champions:** The resource persons from NACOSTI and

KSL will jointly facilitate this session, with support from KIPRE's Data Science and Analytics Section (DSAS) and Data Protection Officer (DPO) Office. The engagement will involve facilitated discussions to identify existing data governance practices, institutional strengths, operational gaps, risks and priority areas requiring further assessment and improvement, with particular attention to governance considerations within scientific research and institutional operations.

3. **Staff sensitisation on the Data Protection Act, 2019:** This session will be led by resource persons from KSL and will focus on the Institute's legal obligations and the practical responsibilities of staff handling personal data. NACOSTI's resource person may complement the session with relevant perspectives on research governance and the regulatory context affecting scientific research, as appropriate.

Through this engagement, KIPRE intends to strengthen the capacity of its Data Governance Champions, promote awareness of institutional governance responsibilities and establish a preliminary evidence base to inform the subsequent consultant-led assessment and development of the Institutional Data Governance Framework.

The proposed activities are tentatively scheduled for late November or early December 2026, subject to consultation and confirmation of availability with NACOSTI and KSL. The specific dates, programme and logistical arrangements will be agreed upon in consultation with the respective institutions.

KIPRE values its collaboration with NACOSTI in advancing research governance, institutional accountability and the responsible management of scientific information. We would appreciate the Commission's favourable consideration of this request and the nomination of a suitably qualified resource person to support this important institutional initiative.

Please accept the assurances of our highest consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Dr. Peter Gichuhi Mwathera, PhD, MBS
Director General
KENYA INSTITUTE OF PRIMATE RESEARCH